



Grovio plant assistant

The Grovio personal plant assistant which is currently up on Kickstarter tries to use IoT solutions to watering plants.
<http://dgit.in/Grovio>

BUYING ADVICE

BOOTCAMP QUERIES

Q I've got a 2014 Mac Mini which I've been using as my daily driver for quite some time now. However, I read about installing Windows on my Mac Mini. I know it's not going to be the usual dual-boot situation like Windows. My concerns are 1. Can I go back to Mac OS after installing Windows 10? 2. Can the two OSes exist without messing with the other? I run a lot of design applications on Mac and I've gotten used to the Mac shortcut keys, so I'd hate it if I had to lose it all. 3 Should I get a PC or upgrade to the next Mac Mini?

—Vijay Padaya

A Hey Vijay, the Apple support page for Bootcamp (<https://support.apple.com/en-in/HT204990>) does list the Mac Mini (Late 2014) model as one of the Windows 10 supported units for Bootcamp. So you can stop worrying about compatibility issues. Simply download Windows 10 ISO from Microsoft's website and fire up Boot Camp Assistant. It'll ask you to point it to the ISO and then ask you how you'd like to partition your storage for Windows. Once that's installed, you'll see the Boot Camp installer prompt. Proceed through the setup. The next Windows update will grab all requisite drivers and install them for you. That's about it. When you want to Boot into Mac OS, right click on the Boot Camp icon in the system tray and select the 'Restart in macOS' option. Or you can simply reboot and keep the 'Option' key pressed when it's booting and it'll prompt you to pick the OS you want to boot into. You can completely get rid of Windows 10 later with Boot Camp Assistant as well if you want.

If you're asking me whether you should get a PC, then yes, any day. However, that's just me. You should go with whatever helps you get your work done in the best possible manner. So if you're used to the whole Mac ecosystem, then

I don't see why you should move away from that. Apple is supposedly working on a new Mac Mini which is going to be around the corner.

LIQUID COOLING FOR CHEAP

Q My friend recently immigrated to Canada and I bought some of his PC components for dirt cheap. Among the spoils I gained were components of a liquid cooling setup. It's mostly soft tubing, a 240 mm radiator, a reservoir and two 120 mm cooling fans. The CPU water block has a nasty crack in it and seems like it could leak water. Maybe that's why I got it for cheap. Anyway, I spotted this really cool EKWB water block for real cheap on eBay and I'm thinking of getting it. Should I take the plunge (couldn't help with the pun). What do you say?

—Sandeep Chauhan

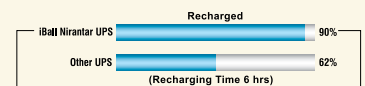
A Well, let's get out the most common mistake people make with liquid cooling. Mixing metals. Let's say the water cooling kit you bought from your friend was a pre-made kit which was either using just copper or just aluminium. You need to ensure that the replacement CPU block is made using the same metal. If not, there's this thing called galvanic corrosion which will slowly eat away the metal with the lower Anodic index. In case of copper and aluminium mixing, the aluminium will suffer corrosion. However, there are platings which can avert corrosion altogether. So check which metal the CPU block uses before making your decision. The other thing you need to worry about is the tubing. Soft tubing, if of a mediocre quality, will overtime discolour and sometimes even become brittle. So you might want to give that tubing a thorough leak check by filling it up or perhaps get new tubing altogether as they are the cheapest component of a liquid cooling setup. Then measure out your tubing and assemble the loop but not inside your system. Take it out on a test drive. Fill it up and let it run for a day or two so that you can be completely sure before installing it in your system. **[E]**



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